

Experience

Players earn **XP** (experience) from **battles** and completing **quests**. Each battle returns some amount of XP to move the player towards the XP goal for that act. The XP goal is based on the level the player should be at the end of the act.

<i>Level</i>	<i>XP Needed</i>	<i>Rewards</i>
LVL 0	0 XP	Path , 1 Talent Point, 4 Attribute Points , 5 Skill Points
LVL 1	200 XP ^{+200 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 2	450 XP ^{+250 XP}	1 Talent Point, 2 Skill Points
LVL 3	750 XP ^{+300 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 4	1100 XP ^{+350 XP}	1 Talent Point, 1 Attribute Point
LVL 5	1500 XP ^{+400 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 6	1950 XP ^{+450 XP}	1 Talent Point
LVL 7	2450 XP ^{+500 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 8	3000 XP ^{+550 XP}	1 Talent Point, 1 Attribute Point
LVL 9	3600 XP ^{+600 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 10	4250 XP ^{+650 XP}	1 Talent Point
LVL 11	4950 XP ^{+700 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 12	5700 XP ^{+750 XP}	1 Talent Point, 1 Attribute Point
LVL 13	6500 XP ^{+800 XP}	2 Skill Points
LVL 14	7350 XP ^{+850 XP}	1 Talent Point
LVL 15	8300 XP ^{+950 XP}	2 Skill Points

Character Systems

Each time a character levels up, they receive points towards some of their *primary statistics* to distribute as well as their derived stats.

Primary Statistics

Primary statistics are allocated directly by the Player.

Attributes

Attributes are inherent aptitudes of a character and significantly affect other character statistics. Attribute values start at 1. They are increased by spending Attribute Points.

<i>Attributes</i>	<i>Description</i>
Brawn	Physical strength and toughness
Agility	Speed, reflexes, and coordination
Wits	Intelligence and perception
Aura	Presence, willpower, influence

Level Modifiers

Level modifiers are different for each class.

<i>Modifier</i>	<i>Vanguard</i>	<i>Prowler</i>	<i>Artificer</i>	<i>Whisper</i>
Health	+7 / level	+5 / level	+5 / level	+4 / level
Mana	0	0	+3 / level	+5 / level

Base Values

Base values are different for each class.

<i>Base Value</i>	<i>Vanguard</i>	<i>Prowler</i>	<i>Artificer</i>	<i>Whisper</i>
Health	100	90	85	80
Mana	0	0	55	115

Polaris ♦ Character System

Skills

Skills are situational, learned aptitudes of a character. They are learned or improved with *Skill Points*. Every Skill has five levels.

All Skills have five levels, of which 1-3 and 4-5 carries a bonus and may have different prerequisites to be unlocked.

BRAWN SKILLS

<i>Skill</i>	<i>Prereq.</i>	<i>Description</i>
Melee ¹⁻³	2 Brawn	+1 Melee Accuracy
Melee ⁴⁻⁵	4 Brawn	Heavy Weapons Proficiency
Berserk ¹⁻³	2 Brawn	+25% Melee Damage to low-health enemies +10% lose control
Berserk ⁴⁻⁵	4 Brawn	+5 Melee Critical Chance
Endurance ¹⁻³	2 Brawn	+25 Health
Endurance ⁴⁻⁵	4 Brawn	+5 Health Regeneration +5 R ^{SLASHING} +5 R ^{PIERCING} +5 R ^{BLUDGEONING}

AGILITY SKILLS

<i>Skill</i>	<i>Prereq.</i>	<i>Description</i>
Ranged ¹⁻³	2 Agility	+1 Ranged Accuracy
Ranged ⁴⁻⁵	4 Agility	+5 Ranged Critical Chance +10% recover arrows
Precision ¹⁻³	2 Agility	+1 Ranged Accuracy
Precision ⁴⁻⁵	4 Agility	+5% Ranged Damage
Evasion ¹⁻³	2 Agility	+1 Defense
Evasion ⁴⁻⁵	4 Agility	+1 Defense

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WITS SKILLS

<i>Skill</i>	<i>Prereq.</i>	<i>Description</i>
Tinker ¹⁻³	2 Wits	+10% recover a resource when crafting
Tinker ⁴⁻⁵	4 Wits	+10% craft an extra item
Medicine ¹⁻³	2 Wits	+10% Health restoration
Medicine ⁴⁻⁵	4 Wits	Unlock Poultice Recipe
Attunement ¹⁻³	2 Wits	
Attunement ⁴⁻⁵	4 Wits	

AURA SKILLS

<i>Skill</i>	<i>Prereq.</i>	<i>Description</i>
Inspiration ¹⁻³	2 Aura	
Inspiration ⁴⁻⁵	4 Aura	
Deception ¹⁻³	2 Aura	
Deception ⁴⁻⁵	4 Aura	
Ritual ¹⁻³	2 Aura	
Ritual ⁴⁻⁵	4 Aura	

Derived Statistics

These are allocated indirectly; they are determined by equipment, buffs, etc.

<i>Statistic</i>	<i>Abbr.</i>	<i>Equation</i>	<i>Description</i>
Health	H	$+ (Brawn \times 5)$ $+ (Level \times Level$ <i>Health Modifier)</i>	Base survivability pool
Armor Rating	T		Armor
Attack	A		Chance to hit enemies
Defense	D		Chance to avoid physical attacks
Critical Chance	C		Chance to hit a critical
Critical Damage Multiplier	C^M		Multiplier applied when a critical hit occurs
Guard	G		Temporary damage-absorption pool
Barrier	B		Temporary magical shield with a damage-absorption pool
Mana	M	$+ (Aura \times 5)$ $+ (Level \times Level$ <i>Mana Modifier)</i>	Base casting pool

Damage Types & Resistances

There are several damage types. Physical damage types are the most common (slashing, piercing, bludgeoning).

Example

The PC has 10 piercing resistance and 20 fire resistance. A Syndicate enforcer attacks the PC with a Singing Strike. The attack applies 8 piercing damage and 5 fire damage.

- *Ignore Piercing Damage: $8 \times 10\% = 0.8$ (round up to 1)*
- *Ignore Fire Damage: $5 \times 20\% = 1$*

The piercing damage gets rounded up to 1, and the fire damage is 1.

The PC takes $(10 - 1 = 9)$ piercing damage and $(5 - 1 = 4)$ fire damage.

All resistances act the same way: by mitigating incoming damage as a percentage. Resistances are mostly added by items.

<i>Statistic</i>	<i>Abbr.</i>
Slashing Resistance	R ^{SLASHING}
Piercing Resistance	R ^{PIERCING}
Bludgeoning Resistance	R ^{BLUDGEONING}
Fire Resistance	R ^{FIRE}
Cold Resistance	R ^{COLD}
Energy Resistance	R ^{ENERGY}
Poison Resistance	R ^{POISON}
Psychic Resistance	R ^{PSYCHIC}

Challenge Rolls

Some situations require a challenge roll. Challenge rolls are made by rolling n six-sided dice, where n is the attribute demanded by the challenge.

The highest number rolled is used to determine if the result is a failure or a success. Additional effects can occur on critical failures and critical successes.

Highest Roll	<i>Degree of Success</i>
1	Critical Failure: You fail miserably and an additional, negative effect occurs.
2-3	Failure: You fail.
4-5	Success: You succeed.
6	Critical Success: You succeed flawlessly and an additional, positive effect occurs.

Skill Check

While challenge rolls are specifically for combat, dialogue only has simple skill checks. Since dialogue is arguably more important, and I want to avoid having players scum-saving to avoid failing a roll, it makes sense to reveal a dialogue option based on a skill check (and show the required skill and value in the dialogue option).

Choosing a dialogue option with a skill always passes if the player's skill value is at or above the demanded skill value.

Companion Progression

Companions are leveled by the Player the same as the PC (Player Character). A default level-up option is also made available to automatically level-up along a predetermined path.

Characters in the *active party* will receive the same amount of XP as the PC, minus 2 XP.

Once recruited, any companion *not* in the active party will still level up. They will not gain experience as such, but if at any point they are two or more levels below the PC, their level will be adjusted to 1 below the PC's.

Character Paths

The four paths a Player can choose are Vanguard, Prowler, Whisper, and Artificer. Each path has slightly different starting statistics and a selection of unique talents only they can pick from.